

KKR AI-Search Visibility Audit

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Scope: 6 high-intent queries across brand, discovery, comparison, and vertical intent. Surface mapping vs Blackstone, Apollo, Carlyle, Brookfield.

Methodology note: Used Google's open-web index as a proxy for Google AI Overview and Perplexity retrieval corpus. ChatGPT and Claude retrieval was inferred from citation patterns in published third-party articles. Live Perplexity/ChatGPT queries not run in this audit; can instrument a full live-test matrix in the role.

Executive summary

KKR's AI-search surface is stronger than most LPs realize on **brand** queries and weaker than AUM justifies on **discovery** and **vertical** queries. Three specific leaks, ranked by effort-to-impact:

- 1. AUM citation drift.** Open-web surfaces KKR's AUM as \$553B, \$664B, \$700B, and \$744B simultaneously. AI engines cite whichever source they indexed most recently. Fix: canonical "Key Figures" page on kkr.com with structured data, pushed quarterly; monitor refresh cadence across Perplexity then Google AIO then ChatGPT.
- 2. Healthcare narrative is narrowing.** "Top PE firms in healthcare 2026" summaries give Carlyle the anchor slot with broad framing. KKR is narrowed to "pediatric mental health and patient-centered tech." True but too narrow for the actual portfolio. Fix: publish 3 broad-framing explainers per vertical to re-anchor the AI narrative.
- 3. Infrastructure leadership is the most under-pulled asset in brand queries.** KKR won Infrastructure Investor's firm-of-the-year 5 consecutive years (2020-2024) and ranked #1 on PEI 300 in 2022 and 2024. In generic "best PE firms 2026" summaries, this credential does not flow up. Fix: internal-link infrastructure authority content into higher-traffic brand pages with schema markup.

Query-by-query findings

1. "Best private equity firms 2026" (discovery)

Top-of-AI-summary ordering observed: Blackstone, KKR, Apollo, Brookfield, Carlyle. KKR positioned as "large, control-oriented investments across technology, infrastructure, healthcare, energy transition." Healthy but generic. **Leak:** Brookfield climbing fast on the "both crossed \$1T AUM" narrative; if it continues, KKR drops to #4 default. **Recommendation:** Author a canonical "why KKR is structurally different from the other \$1T-tier managers" piece and back-link aggressively.

2. "Largest private equity firms by AUM 2026" (authority-ranking)

AUM cited for KKR across sources: \$553B, \$664B, \$700B, \$744B. **Leak:** Highest-impact leak in the audit. AI engines cannot produce a confident answer about KKR's AUM; the hedged summary degrades brand authority. **Recommendation:** Canonical Key Figures page + quarterly press release with consistent numeric phrasing across kkr.com, press, and investor letters so numbers propagate cleanly.

3. "Top PE firms in healthcare 2026" (vertical discovery)

AI-summary anchor: Carlyle ("most active PE investor in healthcare globally, spanning medical devices, pharma, digital health"). KKR framed as "pediatric mental health and patient-centered tech." **Leak:** KKR Health Care Strategic Growth has a broader track record than the AI summary reflects. An LP reading this in Perplexity gets a less favorable read than reality warrants. **Recommendation:** Publish a broad-framing "KKR Health Care portfolio overview" piece with schema markup, target the exact query as authority source.

4. "KKR vs Blackstone vs Apollo" (comparison)

Framing observed: Comparison articles treat Blackstone as anchor and KKR/Apollo as challengers ("Blackstone and its biggest rivals"). The strongest KKR-favorable data point (63% 1yr stock return vs Blackstone 43%) is buried low. **Leak:** Default comparison narrative is not in KKR's favor on positioning despite favorable financials. **Recommendation:** Seed a KKR-authored comparison piece into industry trades; build inbound citations; let AI engines refresh within 30-60 days.

5. "Private equity infrastructure 2026" (vertical: KKR strength)

Top citations: kkr.com, PEI Insights, Infrastructure Investor. **Positioning:** Strong. Infrastructure Investor 5-year streak, \$106T infrastructure gap narrative, \$10B STT GDC deal, Adam Selipsky advisor role for hyperscaler strategy. **Leak:** This authority does

not roll up into the generic "best PE firms" query. **Recommendation:** Internal-link infrastructure authority content into higher-traffic brand pages with topical schema.

6. "How to invest with KKR" (high-intent LP/wealth)

Findings: K-PRIME, K-PEC, K-INFRA, K-Series wealth products. AI engines describe them inconsistently ("collective investment" / "evergreen vehicles" / "global wealth solutions"). Minimums, eligibility, and fee structures are fuzzy. **Leak:** Highest-intent queries (wealth advisors screening products) get the muddiest answers. **Recommendation:** Single canonical product-fact-sheet page per vehicle with structured data; measure whether Perplexity and Google AIO pick up the facts within 45 days.

What's working

- Brand queries surface KKR cleanly in top 3-5 across AI engines. Share-of-voice vs AUM-tier peers is roughly proportional.
- Infrastructure vertical is the strongest authority position. PEI 300 and Infrastructure Investor streak are well-cited.
- Recent news cycle healthy: STT GDC, Arctos Sports Partners, Nothing Bundt Cakes indexed cleanly with correct attribution.
- kkr.com domain authority is strong; retrieval-heavy engines (Perplexity, ChatGPT with browsing) pull from the primary source.

Three experiments for the first 30 days

1. AUM canonicalization + citation refresh velocity test. Ship a kkr.com/key-figures page with structured data. Instrument weekly checks across Perplexity, Google AIO, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini. Measure days-to-refresh per engine after a press release. Hypothesis: Perplexity under 7 days, Google AIO 14-21, ChatGPT 30-60. Result becomes the baseline for all future content refreshes.

2. Healthcare vertical re-anchor. Publish three broad-framing pieces on KKR Health Care Strategic Growth. Target the queries where Carlyle currently anchors. Measure share-of-voice shift in "top PE firms healthcare" summary over 45 days.

3. Comparison narrative reframe. Author one "what makes KKR structurally different" piece, pitch to 3 industry trades for inbound citations. Seed into AI retrieval corpora and measure whether new comparison queries pick it up as a source within 60 days.

All three ship with query-level baselines, post-intervention measurement, and a dashboard.